THE DARK KNIGHT RETURNS

Details **Originally published** The Dark Knight Returns #1-#4 (1986) **Publisher** DC Comics
Writer Frank Miller **Artist** Frank Miller, Klaus Janson **Collected in** The Dark Knight Returns (£14.99)
Available digitally Kindle, Comixology

It's rare that a book set outside of current continuity can have such an impact on its source material. But *The Dark Knight Returns* – alongside *Year One* – is half of Frank Miller's one-two punch that changed Batman forever.

Miller takes advantage of Batman's age and casts him in the rare role of underdog, pitting him against young upstarts, old villains, the police and – in the book's most memorable moments – Superman himself. He might be old, he might have an untested Robin, and he might not hold Gotham's criminals in a state of terror anymore, but he's still the goddamn Batman.

The bulky, ugly art gives the whole thing a post-apocalyptic feel, the grimy look of a world without Batman, and Superman is treated with a rare lack of respect. But that's hardly surprising when the book's loyalties rest squarely with one character – and it's not the one in primary colours.





